APPENDIX A

Develop Reference Card

Keep this next to you before and during a development one-to-one. You don't need to memorize it — glance at it.

Open every development conversation with:

> OPENING QUESTION
>
> *"Walk me through how you've been using AI on your work recently."*

Not "are you using AI?" — that gets a yes or no. "Walk me through" gets a real picture; a sense of where they are usually forms as they talk. Then listen for one of four positions — starting reads, not fixed labels. People move between them as they learn.

Exploring

Signals: Ahead of the team. Specific examples, unprompted. Asks what's next.

Risk: Their learning stays private; they feel unseen.

Next step: Stretch them and make their work visible — e.g., bring one thing they've figured out to the next team meeting.

Question: *"What have you figured out that the rest of the team doesn't know yet?"*

Follow up: ~2 weeks — what they brought, and how it landed.

Complying

Signals: Does it, but vague. No real examples. Low energy — "I use it for drafts," no detail.

Risk: The rule stays a rule and never becomes practice they believe in.

Next step: Connect AI to something they'd actually like to change about their work — a specific starting point, not "experiment more."

Question: *"What part of your work do you wish took less time?"*

Follow up: ~2 weeks — what they found, and what they decided about when to trust the output.

Resisting

Signals: Hesitation. "It doesn't really fit my work." Vague answers, pauses.

Risk: The real concern stays underground; pushing buries it further.

Next step: Surface the concern first, then meet it – job/role fear (name where their judgment stays irreplaceable), quality worry (show the verification checkpoint), skill gap (pair with a colleague; take the stakes off the first try).

Question: *"What's making this feel uncertain for you – specifically?"*

Follow up: ~2–3 weeks – *"Has anything shifted since we talked?"* (not "are you using AI now?").

Struggling

Signals: Tried it, it didn't work. "I've tried but…" Confidence dropping.

Risk: Repeated failure erodes confidence until they give up. Practical and immediate helps; encouragement doesn't.

Next step: Find the specific barrier, then pick one task they can win at – prompt structure (five minutes with a colleague), wrong task type (one task where AI works reliably for their work), skill gap (one targeted step with a clear output).

Question: *"Where exactly does it break down for you?"*

Follow up: ~1 week – not two; confidence erodes fast. *"Did you try it? What happened?"* Name any partial win.

DOING WELL – NO POSITION NEEDED

Some people just have it: real examples, good judgment, steady progress. Don't force a pattern. Name it, agree a step that keeps them going, and move on.

CLOSING ANY STEP – THE THREE-PART TEST

The step can be a small task or a real piece of work. Before you finish, you should both be able to say: *what* they'll try, on *what work*, and *when* you'll talk about how it went. If not, it isn't a step yet.